

Briefing and Preparation for Designing for Real People Workshop

Friday 20 March 2026

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(and seven service design students)

Workshop Overview and preparation

At the DRP workshop on Friday, you are going to try out some key design methods to:

- Illustrate and set a mission to address a problem in a chosen context
- Better relate to people and their experiences in that context
- Identify and visualise issues and opportunities
- Develop ideas and design richer experiences for your target audience

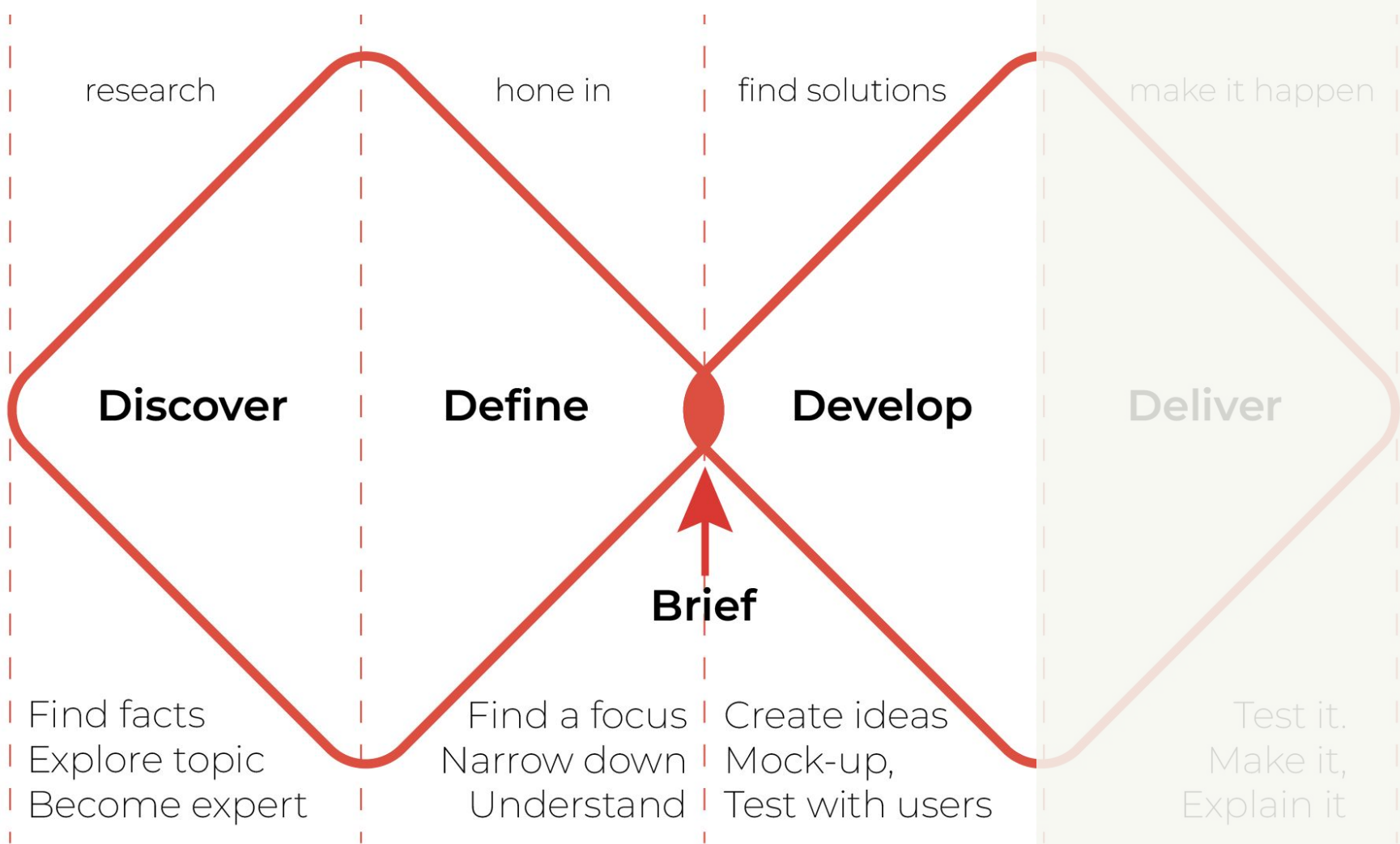
Applying the design methods introduced in this session will help kickstart your projects in May

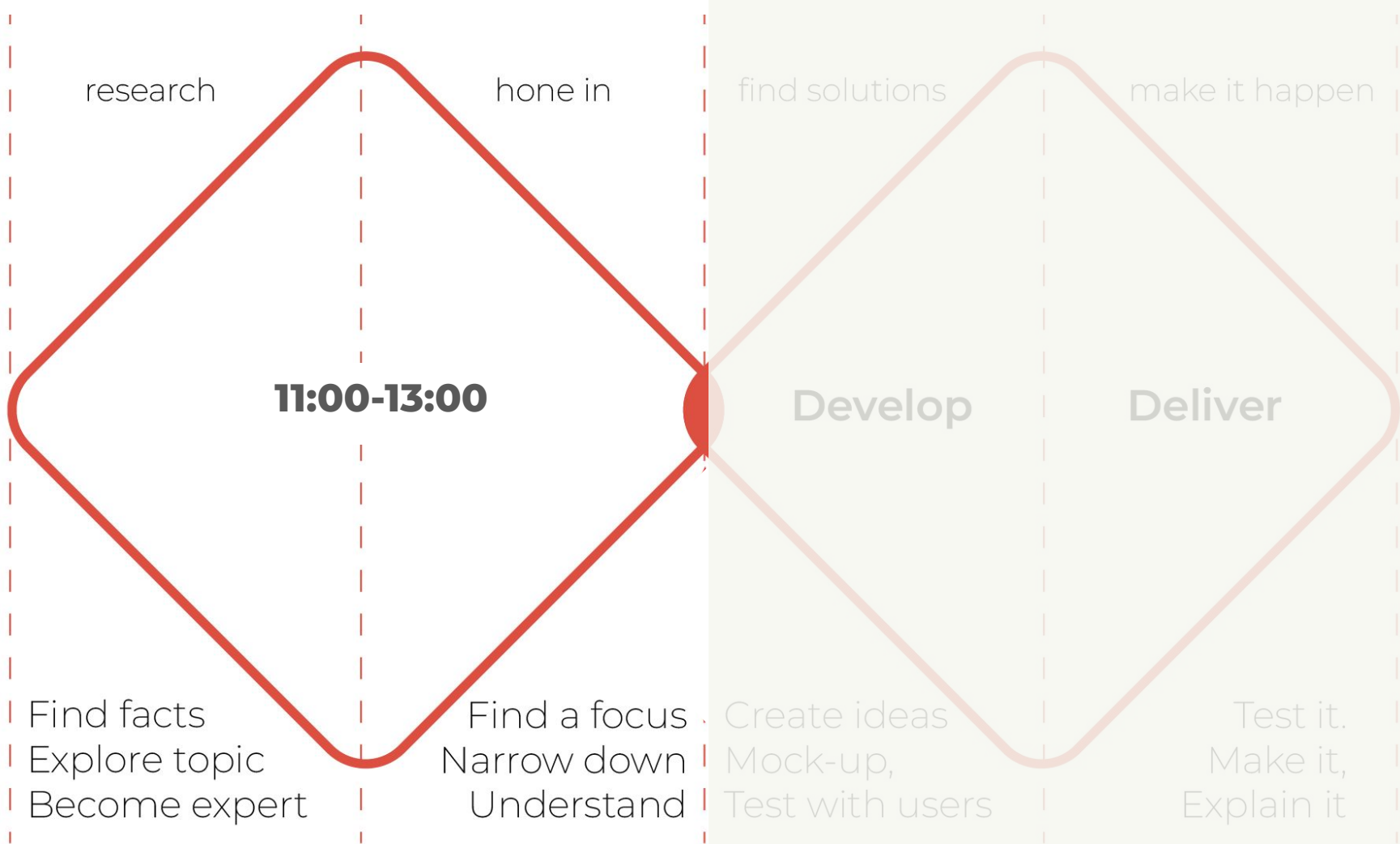
The Double Diamond

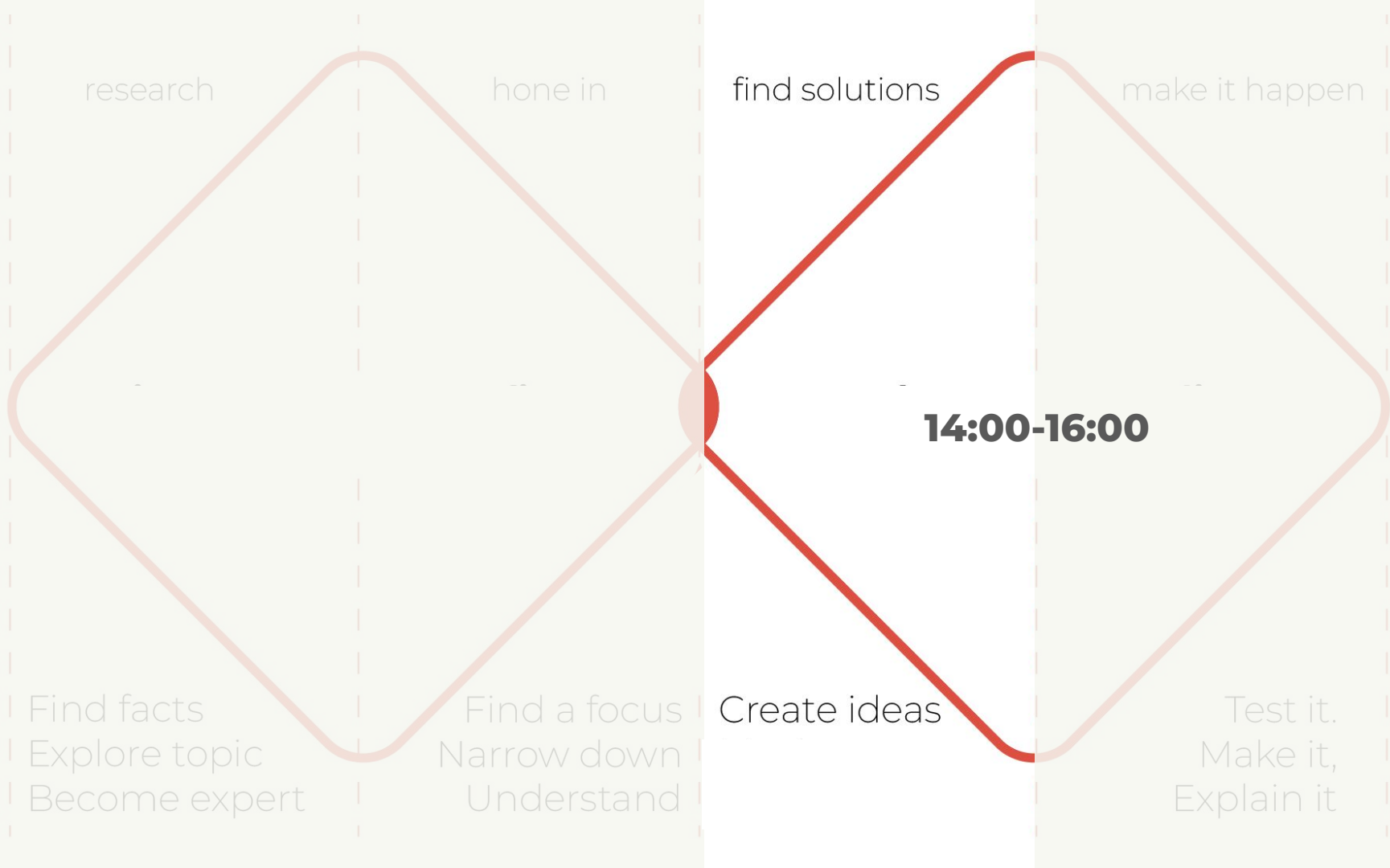


You are going to work in your teams on the first 2/3rd's of the double diamond to:

- Find the most interesting themes within a chosen topic and some associated challenges
- Identify the people connected to this topic, understand their current experience and the problems they face
- Brainstorm ideas to address issues faced by people, and
- Create new and better experiences for them









Prep before workshop

In your teams, choose your favourite topic from the list below

1. **What a waste!** 215 million tonnes of waste is produced in the U.K each year (Waste Direct 2024).
2. **Roundabout** London's workers spend 107 hours commuting annually, more if they have disabilities [Gov.uk, 2017]
3. **Ker-ching** Nearly 60% of UK parents have to help their adult kids, ages 18 to 34, with financial support. [[pewresearch.org](https://www.pewresearch.org), 2024]

Prep before workshop

Once you've chosen your topic, start finding out more now about it through some initial desktop research:

1. Find a sector and specific problem in your chosen topic
2. Find up to 3 important statistics that illustrate the nature of the problem and the impact
3. Write a list of the people most affected by the problem

Example: 'What a waste'

Here's just one direction you could choose

Sector: Construction

Up to THREE important statistics

Eg. According to the latest DEFRA UK Statistics on waste reported in March 2020, in 2016 the UK generated 66.2 million tonnes of non-hazardous construction and demolition waste (C&D waste). This represents 62% of total UK waste generated in 2016. (Environment Agency, 2021)

Some of the people being affected by this issue:

Eg. Architects, developers, contractors, sub-contractors, structural engineers, councils, EPR waste teams.....

Think about these questions as you start your research

RESEARCH IT

- why is this a problem?
 - What exactly IS the problem (break down into at least 5 things)
 - How widespread is this issue? Is it getting worse?
- Who is currently bearing the cost of it?
- What is the impact of doing nothing?
- What global trends are going on around it and making it worse?
 - Who does it affect most?
 - Who else is involved/gets affected by it?
 - How does it make these people feel?
 - What is surprising about it?

On Friday, please sit in your teams.

We look forward to seeing you then and hearing what you're interested in and help you explore further and come up with innovative ideas to address the challenges you've uncovered